



HIRE driver japan · Academy

Manners and etiquette

VVIP Service Training · Instructor's Programme

OCTOBER 2026 EDITION

For instructors and staff. Not for distribution to trainees.

The name board

GOALS

- Greet correctly at airports and hotels while protecting the client.

MANDATORY RULES

White board, bold black printed letters, A4. No handwriting, no marks. Company or brand logo small.

Normal clients: Mr. or Ms. plus surname. Never the full name.

Clients with security, public figures: never the real name. Use a code name or signal agreed with the assistant. A real name reveals where they are.

Hold it at chest height, with both hands, straight. Never while looking at a phone.

Stand where the exit is visible without blocking the flow. Never call out in front of the exit.

In position 30 minutes before arrival; check the flight for delays and report to dispatch.

TEACHING NOTES

Show two samples: a correct one (Mr. Smith) and a wrong one (full name and company in large letters).

EXERCISE

From three client profiles, trainees decide what each name board should say.

COMMON MISTAKES

Writing the full name and flight number for anyone to read.

Greeting, doors, seating, luggage, rain

GOALS

- Perform the sequence from greeting to boarding safely and gracefully.
- Handle rain and a client with shopping.

MANDATORY RULES

The first words: introduce yourself, welcome them, guide them to luggage and car. That is enough.

Open the door only when fully stopped and after checking behind and around; walk round, hand on the frame, warn about the roof edge. Close gently and fully after checking hands, feet and clothing.

Confirm seating in advance. If unknown, gesture to the rear seats and let the client choose.

The driver loads and unloads. Ask whether the client wants to keep a bag of valuables with them.

Shopping bags: never let the client carry them. Say 'Let me take those', load them in the boot or where the client prefers so they cannot tip over, and ask whether fragile items should stay with the client.

Rain: have the umbrella open before the client leaves the building. The umbrella covers the client; the driver may get wet. Walk beside the client to the car, or to the next cover. Open the door first, then close the umbrella. Same on arrival.

Two large black umbrellas: one for the client, one for a companion.

Drop-off: announce 'We will arrive in one minute', open the door after stopping, check for items left behind.

TEACHING NOTES

This chapter is the first scenario on day 3. For the rain scenario, make them do it for real; a watering can or hose is not excessive.

Demonstrate the umbrella angle: tilted towards the driver so the client's shoulders stay dry.

EXERCISE

In the car park, each trainee performs greeting to boarding to drop-off; the others score with Appendix A.

COMMON MISTAKES

Holding the umbrella so the driver stays dry.

Watching the client board with their own shopping bags.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 9

Conduct in the car: do not initiate

GOALS

- Understand and practise silence as a service.

MANDATORY RULES

Never start a conversation unless the client does. No small talk, personal stories or unnecessary questions.

If the client starts a conversation, answer politely, briefly and professionally. No personal questions. Opinions and advice only when clearly asked.

Never comment on the client's calls, meetings, schedule, mood or private matters.

The driver may only speak about safety, the arrival announcement, changes of plan and traffic that changes the timing. Conclusion and time first, in one sentence.

Never interrupt a call or work. Tell them at arrival if needed.

Do not turn round to the client. Phone on silent and untouched. No eating, no gum.

Drive smoothly: no sudden braking, acceleration, lane changes or speeding. Smooth enough for the client to read.

Keep a professional distance. Do not try to build rapport.

TEACHING NOTES

Many Japanese taxi drivers were taught that silence is rude. State the opposite standard clearly here; reading rules 2, 9 and 12 of Appendix D aloud works well.

Practise 'one sentence': traffic, route change and arrival announcement, each in 15 words or fewer.

EXERCISE

A 30-minute mock ride with the instructor as client (chairs will do). The instructor takes a call, reads papers and asks one question. Note when the trainee should and should not speak.

COMMON MISTAKES

Unable to bear silence, starting on the weather or sightseeing.